Eduard Kakosyan

Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada · Canadian Citizen
kakosyaneduard@gmail.com | kakosyaneduard.ca | linkedin.com/in/eduard-kakosyan | github.com/EduardKakosyan

Summary

Hands-on AI engineering lead working directly with clients, from discovery and architecture through integration and rollout. I lead a team of five developers building AI applications, workflow integrations and local-model systems.

Experience

Lead AI Developer (Tech & AI lead, leadership team) February 2025 – Present
AI-First Solutions | ai-first.ca *Halifax, NS*

*Client engineering: **39** projects across 31 organizations, spanning AI Accelerator sprints and custom builds*

- Built RFQ, RFP and legal-review triage agents for HVAC, consulting and recruitment firms (Power Automate).
- Led RAG chat platforms grounded in clients' own content, with eval-gated releases (Next.js, pgvector, Claude).
- Leading an on-prem build: a local-model assistant on the client's own GPU, so the data stays on site.

Architecture & systems integration

- Designed and lead development of Keystone (rolling out): one capability registry generates the app's operations and Claude's MCP tools, so staff and AI share permissions.
- Ran discovery with a UX researcher before the rebuild: leadership interviews and a usage audit replaced an unused scorecard with owned, sourced metrics.
- Cut proposals from days to 30 minutes and connected client meetings to Linear tasks (Fireflies, Claude).

Engineering leadership & enablement

- Hold the leadership team's tech and AI seat; lead development, technical direction and delivery across the team.
- Designed and managed a client's Skills for Hire data science and ML curriculum: **226** learners, 88% completion.
- Ran AI Accelerator sprints, cohort programs and workshops for client teams, CPA firms and a college.

AI Instructor August 2025 – April 2026
ShiftKey Labs, Dalhousie University *Halifax, NS*

- Co-taught an agentic AI course for non-CS students at Dalhousie, who built agents with n8n and Bolt.

Co-Founder October 2024 – January 2025
CarGrep (ShiftKey Build) | cargrep.com *Halifax, NS*

- Built an AI car-recommendation platform with conversational search and streaming answers (GPT-4o).

Selected Projects

Keeper — self-hosted meeting memory on a local model, served over REST, MCP and a web UI 2026
dgx-autonomy — a coding agent that runs unattended on a DGX Spark against tests it can't edit 2026
HUGO — voice assistant for a Reachy Mini robot, with speech and the LLM local on a DGX Spark 2026
HealthByte — LLM personas reacting to real and fake health news | **1st Place, Atlantic AI Summit** May 2025

Skills & Certificates

AI & LLMs: Anthropic Claude, MCP, RAG, pgvector, Voyage, Vercel AI SDK, evals, vLLM, SGLang, Ollama
Languages & Frameworks: Python, TypeScript, SQL, Go, Next.js, React, Node.js, FastAPI
Cloud & Infrastructure: Supabase, PostgreSQL, Azure, AWS, Vercel, Docker, Linux, NVIDIA DGX Spark
Integrations & Automation: Microsoft Graph, Power Automate, Copilot Studio, n8n, Linear, QuickBooks Online
Certificates: AWS Cloud Practitioner, Communication Technologies & Cyber Security (Dalhousie)

Education & Awards

Dalhousie University | CGPA 3.8 Halifax, NS
Bachelor of Computer Science (Co-op) *Graduated May 2025*

- Future Tech Leaders Award · Sexton Scholar Award · Dean's List